

SWAPNIL KUSALE'S SUCCESS MANTRA DOES THE TRICK

The Maharashtrian has **elevated himself** above the rest of India's sporting firmament and into legend after winning the Olympic bronze in the 50m men's three-position event.

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*om tryāmbakam yajāmahe sugandhīm puṣṭi-vardhānam
urvārukam īva bandhānān mṛtyor mukṣīya mā 'mṛtāt*

About a year ago, Swapnil Kusale had this Rig Vedic verse tattooed down his spine. These Sanskrit words are recited during times of great stress and are believed to bestow longevity. Originally, the verse — a *moksha* mantra — was intended to ease the transition from the world of mortals.

This tattoo isn't the only one Kusale has; he also sports an image of Arjuna, the Indian archer prince, on his arm. While Arjuna is synonymous with marksmanship in India, it's the tattoo on Kusale's back that truly symbolises what the 25-year-old has achieved.

Now, Kusale has elevated himself above the rest of India's sporting firmament and into legend after winning an Olympic bronze in the 50m men's three-position event at the Olympic shooting centre in Châteauroux.

His medal was India's third at the 2024 Olympics and the first ever in the 50m three-position event. It's also the first individual medal for an athlete from the state of Maharashtra since K. D. Jadhav won one for wrestling in 1952.

A year ago, Kusale got the verse tattooed for spiritual support at a

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